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CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008



G. Madhavan Nair & Team Chandrayaan

The biggest and the most credible awards in the Indian media CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008, in partnership with Hindustan Times, are widely acclaimed for their consistency in recognising and honouring those illustrious Indians who have made the country proud by contributing towards building Brand India through their relentless hard work and outstanding achievements.

This year, the rigorous 4-tier selection process involved The Editorial Board, The Jury, The Eminent Indians and The Citizens to ensure credibility, transparency and acceptance. The jury included some most credible and recognised personalities like Soli Sorabjee, Shobhana Bhartia, Deepak Parekh, Nandan Nilekani, Mohanlal and Geet Sethi.

Across the 6 categories of politics, sports, business, entertainment, public service and global Indian, the list of nominees threw up some of the most recognised and deserving names. Each one of them was someone who had inspired the whole nation, riding on a priceless blend of dynamic vision, immeasurable commitment and immense resolve. In addition, 3 special awards were declared for people whose contribution was found to be too broad, long lasting and enveloping for the society and thus, truly beyond any categorisation.

The Grand Finale

At the scintillating Grand Finale held at Hotel Taj Palace in New Delhi, the winners took their well-deserved place under the spotlight. The gala event was attended by a host of eminent personalities including ministers, senior politicians, administrators, media and entertainment professionals, journalists, and sportspersons like P Chidambaram, Murli Manohar Joshi, Arun Jaitley, Kapil Sibal, M S Gill, Abhishek Manu Singhvi, Satish Gujral, Nawab Pataudi, Suhel Seth, Sharmila Tagore, Murli Kartik to name a few.

In each category, the winner was chosen after applying the most stringent of parameters to judge them. Nitish Kumar, the Hon'ble Chief Minister of Bihar, was chosen as the CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008 - Politics for scripting a growth saga in one of the most underdeveloped states in the country; Abhinav Bindra emerged as the CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008 - Sports for his exceptional performance at the Beijing Olympics; Aditya Puri, Managing Director of HDFC Bank, was the CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008 - Business for displaying great financial acumen in these tough times; Aamir Khan, the ace Bollywood actor and director was adjudged the CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008 - Entertainment for his preference towards the cause of superior cinema; G. Madhavan Nair & Team Chandrayaan were felicitated as CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008 - Public Service for realising a crucial scientific dream and A. R. Rahman was declared the CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008 - Global Indian for leaving the biggest Indian imprint on the global music scenario.

In the end, **G. Madhavan Nair & Team Chandrayaan** were honoured with most prestigious award of them all the **CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008** for their singular and selfless commitment towards a larger national cause.

Special Awards

Some of the special awardees were **Dilip Kumar** CNN IBN Indian of the Year 2008 Lifetime Achievement Award; **Late Tukaram Omble** - CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008 Extraordinary Service to the Nation Award; **Mumbai Police** CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008 Extraordinary Service to the Nation Award and **Sheila Dikshit** - CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2008 Special Achievement Award.